Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	29 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	FreelanceHub — MERN Stack Freelancing Platform
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

1. Problem Statement Definition

How might we build a secure, easy-to-use freelancing platform that lets clients post projects and choose the right freelancer through a transparent application process — while giving freelancers a simple way to find open work, apply with a proposal, track their application status, and collaborate with the client in real time once they are hired?

2. Brainstormed Idea Groups

- **User Experience Features:** Role-based registration and login, a client dashboard for posting projects with title, description, budget, duration and required skills, a freelancer page to browse and filter open projects, an application form with proposal, rate and portfolio link, and a My Applications page showing Pending, Approved or Rejected status.
- **Collaboration & Communication Features:** A built-in real-time chat powered by Socket.io that unlocks between the client and the freelancer once an application is approved, with messages appearing instantly on both screens and saved in MongoDB.
- **Secure Infrastructure Features:** JWT-based authentication with bcrypt-hashed passwords, a role field separating clients, freelancers and admins, protect and authorize middleware guarding sensitive routes, ProtectedRoute on the frontend, and secrets kept in a .env file outside GitHub.
- **Client Management Features:** A My Projects list for each client and a View Applications page showing every proposal, rate and portfolio link, with Approve and Reject actions that update the status the freelancer sees on their dashboard.

3. Idea Prioritization Matrix

- **High Importance / High Feasibility (Built):** JWT authentication with role-based access, project posting and browsing with filters, applications with proposal, rate and portfolio link, approve/reject workflow with status tracking, real-time chat with Socket.io, and a clean React interface with React Toastify notifications.
- **High Importance / Lower Feasibility (Near-Term Enhancements):** Online payments with escrow to secure client–freelancer transactions, file uploads for project submissions, and cloud deployment on platforms like Render and Vercel.
- **Lower Importance / Future Polish:** A ratings and review system, a full admin panel for user verification and dispute handling, and email notifications.